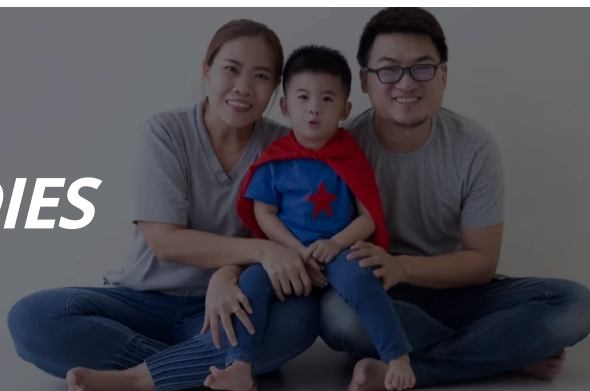


PRESCHOOL SUBSIDIES



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OVERVIEW OF THE INFANT AND CHILDCARE SUBSIDY SCHEME

Types of subsidies

There are two types of subsidies under the infant and childcare subsidy scheme:

- **Basic Subsidy**

All Singapore Citizen (SC) children enrolled in an [ECDA-licensed infant or childcare centre](#) are eligible for a Basic Subsidy.

- **Additional Subsidy**

Your child will be eligible for Additional Subsidy if:

1. The main applicant (mother or single father) is working at the point of the subsidy application; and
2. The family's gross monthly household income (HHI) is \$12,000 or below; or
3. The per capita income (PCI) is \$3,000 or below for households consisting of 5 or more family members who are related by blood, marriage, and/or legal adoption, and who share the same registered residential address.

[Find out how HHI and PCI are assessed](#) →

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Subsidy amount



This table shows the amount of preschool subsidies that an SC child enrolled in a full-day infant or childcare programme is eligible to receive. The main applicant refers to the mother. If she is unavailable (for divorced, separation or widowed cases), the applicant will be the single father.

	Working main applicant		Non-working main applicant	
	Basic Subsidy	Additional Subsidy	Basic Subsidy	Additional Subsidy
Infant Care (aged 2 - 18 months)	\$600	Up to \$710	\$150	NA
Childcare (aged 18 months - 6 years)	\$300	Up to \$467	\$150	NA

The exact amount of preschool subsidies that your child may receive depends on the following:

- The **working status of the main subsidy applicant** at the point of the subsidy application or [fixed point of subsidy assessment](#).

A 'working main applicant' refers to the mother (or single father for divorced, separation or widowed cases) who works at least 56 hours per month. This includes full-time, part-time and freelance work arrangements.

- Your family's **means-tested income** at the point of the subsidy application or fixed point of subsidy reassessment.
- Your child's **preschool programme** (infant care or childcare) and **service type** (full-day, half-day, or flexi-care), and **programme fee**.

Note: Household or personal expenses are not considered in the subsidy assessment.

Estimate your child's preschool subsidy

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Please visit [Search for preschools | LifeSG – Services](#) and log in with your Singpass to search for preschools with information on estimated fees after subsidies. You may also refer to the table below to find out



amount of preschool subsidy your child may be eligible for, based on your household income (HHI) or per capita income (PCI).

 [Childcare and Infant Care subsidy tables](#) 

The amount of subsidies reflected is an estimate. The actual subsidy amount will be determined based on verified details, such as screened income.

Note:

- The approved preschool subsidies are valid until the next fixed point of subsidy assessment or until your child withdraws from the preschool, whichever comes first. [Learn more about the fixed points of subsidy assessment](#).
- Your child must attend preschool for **at least one day** in a month to be eligible for subsidies for that month.
- The subsidies will be paid directly to the preschool, and you are only required to pay the infant or childcare fees nett of subsidies.

Non-working main subsidy applicant

If your Singapore Citizen (SC) child is in a childcare programme and your gross monthly household income is \$6,000 and below or per capita income is \$1,500 and below

From 9 Dec 2024, families with an SC child enrolled in a childcare programme and a gross monthly household income of \$6,000 and below or per capita income of \$1,500 and below will qualify for full childcare subsidies (i.e., a basic subsidy and means-tested additional subsidy, if eligible). This applies regardless of the main subsidy applicant's working status.

Eligible children will receive the full childcare subsidies until the next [fixed point of assessment](#).

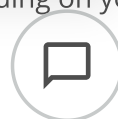
If your SC child is in an infant care programme, or if your SC child is in a childcare programme and your gross monthly household income is above \$6,000 or per capita income is above \$1,500

You may apply for time-limited full childcare subsidy support under Special Approval (SA) if the main subsidy applicant is unable to work due to a specified reason and:

- (i) Your SC child is enrolled in an infant care programme, or
- (ii) Your SC child is enrolled in a childcare programme, and your gross monthly household income is above \$6,000 or per capita income is above \$1,500.

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If granted, these higher subsidies will be provided for a time-limited period, which varies depending on your circumstances.



Qualifying reasons for Special Approval (SA)

Non-working main applicants (refers to the mother (or single father for divorced, separation or widowed cases))

As the main subsidy applicant, you may apply for time-limited higher preschool subsidy support under SA if you are not working due to one of the following reasons:

- Looking for a job
- Studying, training or on course for at least 56 hours per month
- Pregnant
- Medically unfit for work due to hospitalisation, long-term illness and/or permanent disability
- Taking care of a special needs child (includes enrolled child)
- Taking care of a sick family member who requires a full-time caregiver
- Caring full-time for a younger child aged 24 months and below who is not enrolled in a preschool
- Incarcerated

Note: Unless otherwise stated, you are required to provide supporting documents for your application. Refer to the checklist for more information:



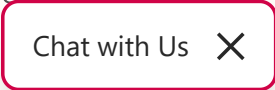
[Supporting Documents Checklist](#) 

Non-parent caregivers

If you are a non-parent caregiver (e.g. legal guardian, guardian, foster parent, head of a children's home) caring for an SC child enrolled in an infant or childcare centre, you may also apply to receive higher subsidies on a time-limited basis.

Note: Foster parents who are already receiving a fostering allowance from the Ministry of Social and Family Development are not eligible for additional subsidy.

Households under HDB's Public Rental Scheme or MSF's ComCare Assistance

Families who are tenants of a rental flat under the HDB's Public Rental Scheme or are beneficiaries of ComCare Short-to-Medium-Term or Long-Term Assistance will be eligible for **maximum**  **lies** under SA until the next fixed point of subsidy assessment.

Example: If your SC child is enrolled in a full-day childcare programme, you will be eligible for a B



Subsidy (BS) of \$300 and the maximum Additional Subsidy (AS) of \$467, subject to a minimum co-payment of \$3.

Minimum Co-payment

Notwithstanding the provision of preschool subsidies, families are subject to a minimum co-payment of the fees. The minimum co-payment amount is the minimum amount of preschool fees you must pay.

The subsidy you are eligible for will be adjusted based on the minimum co-payment. The minimum co-payment increases progressively as your household or per capita income rises.

Examples

If you are a working mother with an SC child in a full-day childcare programme and your family's gross monthly household income is \$3,000 and below, you are eligible for a basic subsidy of \$300. In addition, you may be eligible for an additional subsidy of \$467. This qualifies you for a total subsidy of \$767.

If your child's programme fee is \$740, you might assume that the fee payable is \$0, since subsidy is higher than programme fee. However, you are subject to the \$3 minimum co-payment applicable for your household income tier for full-day childcare programme. As such, the actual amount of childcare subsidies you will receive will be \$737. This includes an additional subsidy of \$437, after accounting for the \$3 minimum co-payment you need to pay.

How to apply for preschool subsidies

The preschool will assist you with the subsidy application at the point of your child's enrolment. You may also apply for a subsidy reassessment if there is a change in your family's circumstances during your child's enrolment at the preschool.

[Learn how to apply →](#)

Note

ECDA is progressively rolling out a digital subsidy application platform via LifeSG to the preschool sector to enable parents to apply for pre-school subsidies online. Parents whose children are in selected preschools will be able to do so from **9 Dec 2024**.

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By **end-Mar 2025**, all parents will be able to apply for pre-school subsidies via LifeSG, reducing the time spent on such applications that are currently done manually via hardcopy or electronic form.



Please approach your preschool if you need clarifications on the subsidy application process that applies to your centre.

Related Questions

- [Is my child eligible for the preschool subsidy after missing a month of attendance due to a medical issue?](#)
- [As a single father, can I apply for preschool subsidy?](#)
- [Can I apply for the subsidy if my spouse is incarcerated and unable to sign the subsidy application form?](#)
- [What should I do if the preschool charged the full fee without applying my subsidies?](#)

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